TECHNICALLY PERFECT

A merit-based focus on research and the latest innovations, and its position as a student start-up hub, keep BITS Pilani firmly planted at the top

By **SONAL KHETARPAL**

5 REASONS WHY IT IS THE BEST

1 BITS Pilani's Practice School gets students industry exposure very early on. They also get two paid internships—in the second and fourth year—which adds up to almost eight months of industry exposure built into the curriculum. At the heart of this is the 125,000-strong alumni network.

2 Last year, BITS raised Rs 180 crore from the government and industry for research, up from Rs 98 lakh in 2020. In 2024 alone, they filed 179 patents. Many of these are now licensed, a key reason for its standing, next only to the IITs.

3 The start-ups incubator offers constant handholding to students. The alumni-supported angel investor network BIT SPARK helps with global mentorship, funding and market access. Student startups incubated at BITS have touched $1 billion valuation.

4 Students are admitted purely on merit, with no management quotas or lateral entries; 99 per cent students get placed.

5 New courses include MSc in Semiconductor and Nanoscience and BTechs in Environmental and Sustainability Engineering.

TOP 10 COLLEGES 2025

	RANK 2025	RANK 2024	COLLEGE	CITY
↔	1	1	BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE PILANI (BITS PILANI)	Pilani
↔	2	2	INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY, HYDERABAD	Hyderabad
↔	3	3	BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY MESRA (BIT MESRA)	Ranchi
↔	4	4	MANIPAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY (MIT)	Manipal
↔	5	5	M.S. RAMAIAH INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY	Bengaluru
↔	6	6	B.M.S. COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING	Bengaluru
↔	7	7	SVKM'S DWARKADAS J. SANGHVI COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING	Mumbai
↑	8	9	SYMBIOSIS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY	Pune
↑	9	10	PSG COLLEGE OF TECHNOLOGY	Coimbatore
↑	10	11	GALGOTIAS COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY	Greater Noida